

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

- The patient reports long-term sadness , feels life is cursed , difficulty in decision making , hopelessness , worsening suicidal ideations , and guilt .
- These symptoms are also noted to be worsening over the past 2 weeks .
- The patient has no symptoms of mania or psychosis .
- He also does not show signs of anhedonia , which is the inability to feel pleasure in previously enjoyed activities .
- The patient also does not display traits of paranoid personality disorder , which includes unwarranted suspicions and unease .
- However , the long-term sadness coupled with worsening symptoms and a history of depression and suicidal ideations are characteristics of Double Depression .

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</think>< answer>A. The patient is at risk for double depression.</answer>

